Verbs with Indirect Object Construction

Verbs in which the indirect object act as the actual subject of the sentence, we use the structure of **Subject + Indirect Object Pronoun + Verb**

Common Verbs with Indirect Object Constructions

Français	English
Plaire	To please
Dégoûter	To disgust
Manquer	To miss
Passionner	To express passion
Dire	To suggest an activity
Rester	To express when something is remaining
Arriver	To occur / To happen, something to someone
Falloir	To need / To be necessary / To be lacking
Suffire	To be enough

Plaire - to please (to like something)

The verb plaire means to please. We use it to express a like or dislike. For example, in English we can say: I like this music **or** This music pleases me. It's the same thing, but the formation is different.

subject (The thing/person that is being liked) + me/te/lui/nous/vous/leur + plaire

Je plais	Nous plaisons
Tu plais	Vous plaisez
Il/Elle/On plaît	Ils/Elles plaisent

Français	English
Merci pour ce joli cadeau ! Ça me **plaît** beaucoup.	Thank you for this beautiful gift. I like it a lot.
Je prépare souvent des surprises pour ma femme. J'espère que ça lui **plaît.**	I often prepare surprises for my wife. I hope she likes it.
Elle me **plaît** trop !	I like her a lot (in informal situations, we sometimes use trop in a positive sense)
Je me demande si je lui **plais** aussi.	I wonder if he likes me too.
(Au restaurant) Serveur : Ça vous a **plu ?**	(At the restaurant) Server: Did you like it?
Tes habitudes ne me **plaisent** pas.	Your habits don't please me. I don't like your habits.

Dégoûter - To disgust

Je dégoûte	Nous dégoûtons
Tu dégoûtes	Vous dégoûtez
Il/Elle/On dégoûte	Ils/Elles dégoûtent

Français	English
Tu me **dégoûtes** !	You disgust me !
Les lézards me **dégoûtent.**	Lizards disgust me.
Ne lui donne pas d'épinards. Ça me **dégoûte**.	Do not give him spinach. It disgusts me.
Le fromage bleu, ça plaît à certains et ça **dégoûte** les autres.	Blue cheese, it pleases some people and it disgusts others.

Manquer - to miss

Manquer has several meanings: to miss, to lack, or to regret the absence (miss). The last meaning uses inverted word order, just like plaire.

Je manque	Nous manquons
Tu manques	Vous manquez
Il/Elle/On manque	Ils/Elles manquent

To miss the absence (of somebody or something)

Français	English
Tu me **manques** !	I miss you!
Ta ville te **manque** ?	Do you miss your city?
Sa famille **manque** beaucoup au soldat.	The soldier misses his family a lot.
Le bon fromage me **manque** depuis que je suis rentrée en Inde.	I miss the good cheese ever since I came back to India.

To miss (To fail to catch)

Français	English
J'ai **manqué** le bus.	I missed the bus.
Tu as **manqué** la réunion aujourd'hui.	You missed the meeting today.

To lack

Français	English
Tu **manques** de confiance en toi.	You lack self-confidence.
Cette carte **manque** d'options vegan.	This menu lacks vegan options.
Ce plat **manque** de sel.	This dish lacks salt.

With “ Il ” (Impersonal Subject) + (Indirect Object Pronoun) + Manquer + Object

Français	English
Il nous **manque** un document.	We're missing one document.
Il me **manque** un kilo de farine.	I'm missing one kilogram of flour.
Il **manque** du piment dans ce plat.	This dish is missing some chilli.

Passionner - to be passionate

We use this verb to express something that we’re passionate about. One way of saying this (that we already know) is :

I am passionate about painting.
Je suis passionné(e) par la peinture.

But we can also formulate this using the indirect object construction of verb passionner.

Français	English
La peinture, ça me **passionne** !	Painting is my passion !
Les courses à cheval me **passionnent** beaucoup!	I am passionate about horse racing.
Qu'est ce qui vous **passionne** ?	What is your passion?

Se passionner pour qqch

Français	English
Je **me passionne** pour les sports nautiques.	I am passionate about nautical sports.
Elle **se passionne** pour le journalisme.	She is passionate about journalism.
Tu **te passionnes** pour les motos n'est-ce pas?	You are passionate about bikes, right?

Dire

We can use the verb dire with indirect object to propose an activity or an idea to somebody.

Usually we say “do you want to go to the cinema?” or **tu veux aller au cinéma.**

But we can say this using the following structure, too

Ça/Cela (As Subject) + Indirect Object Pronoun + Dire + de + Infinitive

Français	English
Ça **te dit d'**aller au cinéma?	Would you like to go to the cinema?
Ça **vous dit de** continuer cette discussion demain?	Would you like to continue this discussion tomorrow?
Je ne sais pas si ça **lui dit d'**aller voir un psychologue.	I don't know if he would like to go see a psychologist.

Rester

We know that **rester** means to stay (not to be confused with **“se reposer”** which means to take a rest). But we can also use it to express **when something is remaining or left.**

In this context, rester uses indirect object construction.

Français	English
Il me **reste** deux formulaires à remplir pour mon visa.	I still have two forms to fill out for the visa
Est-ce qu'il te **reste** de la place dans ton grenier ?	Do you have any space left in your attic?
Il ne me **reste** que deux œufs.	I have only two eggs left.
Il nous **reste** à interroger M. Lafay.	We still have to interrogate Mr. Lafay.

Arriver

We know that arriver literally means to arrive. **J'arrive dans 5 minutes.**

But it can also mean "**To occur / To happen something to someone** "
When it is used with an indirect object construction.

This structure is as follows:

Ça / Cela/ Il + Indirect Object Pronoun + Arriver

Français	English
Je note tout ce qui **m'arrive** dans mon journal.	I note down everything that happens to me in my diary.
Il **m'arrive** d'oublier les prénoms de mes étudiants quelquefois.	Sometimes it happens to me that I forget the names of my students.
Ça **t'arrive** de penser à moi quelquefois ?	Does it ever occur to you to think about me?

Falloir - to be necessary

The irregular French verb **falloir** means "**to need," "to be necessary," or "to be lacking."**

Since falloir is an impersonal verb, it has only one conjugation in each tense and mood: **the third-person singular**, which must be followed by an infinitive or a noun.

Il faut + Verb / Noun

The most common usage of falloir is to give advice. Instead of using the verb devoir (which signifies more of an obligation) we can use falloir to give general (impersonal) advice, instruction, or suggestion.

Please note that il faut + infinitive as impersonal advice can be translated as below